```
<%= select_tag(:city_id, options_for_select(...)) %>
```

`options_for_select` allows you to pre-select an option by passing its value.

```
<%= options_for_select([['Lisbon', 1], ['Madrid', 2], ...], 2) %>

output:

<option value="1">Lisbon</option>
<option value="2" selected="selected">Madrid</option>
...
```

Whenever Rails sees that the internal value of an option being generated matches this value, it will add the `selected` attribute to that option.

The second argument to `options_for_select` must be exactly equal to the desired internal value. In particular if the value is the integer `2` you cannot pass `"2"` to `options_for_select` - you must pass `2`. Be aware of values extracted from the `params`hash as they are all strings.

when `:include_blank` or `:prompt` are not present, `:include_blank` is forced true if the select attribute `required` is true, display `size` is one and `multiple` is not true.

You can add arbitrary attributes to the options using hashes:

```
<%= options_for_select(
  [
    ['Lisbon', 1, { 'data-size' => '2.8 million' }],
    ['Madrid', 2, { 'data-size' => '3.2 million' }]
  ], 2
) %>

output:

<option value="1" data-size="2.8 million">Lisbon</option>
<option value="2" selected="selected" data-size="3.2
million">Madrid</option>
...
```

3.2 Select Boxes for Dealing with Models

In most cases form controls will be tied to a specific database model and as you might expect Rails provides helpers tailored for that purpose. Consistent with other form helpers, when dealing with models you drop the `_tag` suffix from `select_tag`:

```
# controller:
@person = Person.new(city_id: 2)
# view:
<%= select(:person, :city_id, [['Lisbon', 1], ['Madrid', 2], ...]) %>
```

Notice that the third parameter, the options array, is the same kind of argument you pass to `options_for_select`. One advantage here is that you don't have to worry about pre-selecting the correct city if the user already has one - Rails will do this for you by reading from the `@person.city_id` attribute.

As with other helpers, if you were to use the `select` helper on a form builder scoped to the `@person`object, the syntax would be:

```
# select on a form builder
<%= f.select(:city_id, ...) %>
```

You can also pass a block to `select` helper:

```
<%= f.select(:city_id) do %>
  <% [['Lisbon', 1], ['Madrid', 2]].each do |c| -%>
    <%= content_tag(:option, c.first, value: c.last) %>
  <% end %>
<% end %>
```